

# What Is The Sticky Keys Exploit? How It Works & Examples

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 [twingate.com/blog/glossary/sticky keys exploit](https://twingate.com/blog/glossary/sticky-keys-exploit)

## How does the Sticky Keys Exploit Work?

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To execute the Sticky Keys exploit, an attacker first gains physical access to the target machine. They then boot the system into Windows Startup Repair mode, which can be accessed either from the host operating system or via an installation device. From here, they open a Command Prompt window.

Next, the attacker navigates to the ``System32`` folder and replaces the Sticky Keys executable file (``sethc.exe``) with the Command Prompt executable (``cmd.exe``). This is typically done using a series of commands to back up the original ``sethc.exe`` file and copy ``cmd.exe`` in its place. Once the replacement is complete, the system is rebooted.

Upon reboot, the attacker can trigger the Sticky Keys feature by pressing the Shift key five times at the login screen. Instead of launching the Sticky Keys dialog, this action opens a Command Prompt with administrative privileges. From this elevated Command Prompt, the attacker can execute various commands to manipulate the system, such as creating new user accounts or resetting passwords, thereby gaining full control over the machine.

# Change pc password with command prompt

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 [superuser.com/questions/1212911/change-pc-password-with-command-prompt](https://superuser.com/questions/1212911/change-pc-password-with-command-prompt)

You need administrative privileges and you need to know your username.

From the command prompt, enter the following command, and replace `<username>` with your actual username:

```
net user <username> *
```

Then enter the new password.